



Imaging Pradip Ingale

Are You Game?

'Gaming' consoles are fast becoming the ultimate home entertainment solution

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Imagine you are in the middle of a race and suddenly, getting bored, decide to quit the game and watch a movie. A little later, even the movie turns out to be a drag and you decide to listen to some music from your voluminous MP3 collection. But suddenly you feel the need to check your e-mail too. Now, you need not shuttle between devices for performing these routine tasks. The new incarnations of Xbox—the Xbox 360—and the PlayStation 3 (PS3) allow you to do all this and more at the flick of a shiny button!

In this age of demanding consumerism and cutthroat competition, you need not settle for shoddy, below-par graphics and low-grade gaming machines anymore. The next-generation consoles are here, and they're here with all their guns blazing. Featuring more processing power than yesteryear's supercomputers, these 'gaming' consoles are fast becoming the ultimate home entertainment solution.

These devices—the Xbox 360 and PS3—let you play music, as well as movies on a screen, apart from giving you a brilliant gaming experience.

The advancements in the hardware inside these consoles is nothing short of path-breaking. Let's take a look under the bonnet of these babies.

The Cell Processor

The Cell Processor made headlines when it was released, and is deemed to be the future of computing. The basics of the Cell aren't too difficult to understand—what is difficult to understand is why didn't they think of the design earlier!

The Cell was jointly developed by IBM, Sony and Toshiba, and is touted to have cores operating in excess of 4 GHz! Remember that the fastest Intel Processor is still at 3.8 GHz, and AMD's Fx 55 runs at a mere 2.6 GHz!

To give a very basic idea of how the Cell works, consider this: if you need to solve a complex problem, you can do it in two ways—you either call in a super-genius with an IQ of 160, or